

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Scenario 02

Who can see the Copilot Dashboard & its reports — and why two colleagues on the same licence differ

TYPICALLY REPORTED BY

A user whose colleague (same team, similar licence) sees nothing or a permission-denied page — or an admin asking “who is *supposed* to see this, and how do I grant or restrict it?”

SURFACES INVOLVED

`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` , M365 Admin Center (VFAM), Entra ID

ROLES TOUCHED

Global Admin, Insights Admin, AI Admin, Insights Analyst, qualified senior leaders, explicitly assigned users, delegates, people-managers

VERSION

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Quick answer

The **Reports** surface shows reports to people who already have a qualifying Copilot Dashboard access source. Administrative roles are independent and non-cumulative: **AI Administrator does not automatically receive a Dashboard view, and Insights Administrator receives neither analyst rights nor automatic viewing.** Entitlement and Viva feature access management (VFAM) remain separate gates that can still block a qualified user.

The access model — exact access sources plus gates

Access source	How it is obtained
Global Administrator	Role-derived automatic access
Qualified senior leader	Automatic identification from supported hierarchy and tenant criteria
Explicitly assigned user	Added through Dashboard access management
Insights Analyst on Global partition	Insights Analyst role plus Global partition assignment
Manager	Manager Settings enabled; valid hierarchy, entitlement, and minimum
Eligible delegate	An eligible Dashboard user delegates access
AI Administrator / Insights Administrator only	Administrative role assignment
Gate: VFAM	Any user or group
Gate: entitlement	Required Viva Insights / Copilot service plan

The diagnosis reduces to three questions: **Which exact access source grants my scope? Do I have the required entitlement? Is VFAM or current service/rollout state blocking me?**

Sources: Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 18 August 2026), Roles in Viva Insights (Last updated 7 July 2026), Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (13 August 2026), Delegate access to the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Copilot insights (Last updated 9 February 2026), and Configure manager settings (Last updated 23 July 2026).

The most likely answer is “working as designed”

Before hunting for a broken setting: if your colleague is an **individual contributor** with no Global Administrator role, qualifying senior-leader status, explicit assignment, Global-partition analyst assignment, manager scope, or delegation, they are correctly seeing nothing. An AI Administrator or Insights Administrator role alone does not change that result.

30-second diagnosis

1. **Should the colleague see it at all?** Check every access source in the matrix. If none applies, **stop: this is working as designed.**
2. **Which source grants *your* access?** Confirm role, explicit assignment, Global partition, senior-leader eligibility, Manager Settings, or delegation. Do not infer viewing from AI Administrator or Insights Administrator.
3. **Colleague is a manager but sees nothing?** Confirm Manager Settings is ON
(`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` → **Admin** → **Manager settings** → “Grant managers scoped access”), their team meets the minimum team size (default 10, floor 5, manager counts), and their `Manager` attribute is populated.
4. **Should qualify but still can’t load the surface?** Check for a **VFAM gate** blocking their group, then confirm their Viva Insights / Copilot licence.

Causes ranked by likelihood

#	Cause
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1	The colleague has no qualifying access source. <i>Working as designed.</i>
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2	You are a Global Administrator, or you have another company-wide access source; the colleague does not.
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3	Manager Settings is OFF tenant-wide.
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4	The colleague's team is below the minimum team size.
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5	The colleague's Manager attribute (or manager hierarchy) isn't populated.
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6	You received a delegation; the colleague did not.
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7	A VFAM gate blocks the colleague's web-app or Copilot Dashboard access.
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8	The colleague lacks the required Viva Insights / Copilot entitlement.
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9 Recent change hasn't propagated yet.

Most common misdiagnosis

This is usually escalated as “the same licence behaves differently for two people — it must be a bug.” In practice the users differ on an access source, hierarchy, assignment, partition, delegation, or gate. Identical licences do *not* imply identical Dashboard access — entitlement is necessary but never sufficient.

Surface vs. scope — keep these separate

Two different questions are easy to conflate:

- **Does the dashboard / Reports surface appear at all?** → governed by an exact access source from the matrix, entitlement, VFAM, and current service/rollout state.
- **Does a *manager* see *team-level* data within it?** → governed by Manager Settings + manager hierarchy + minimum team size.

Diagnose which question you're actually answering before chasing a fix.

Worked example — the executive sponsor who isn't a manager

This case comes up constantly, so it's worth walking through end-to-end because the intuitive answer is the *wrong* one.

The situation

James is the executive sponsor of the organisation's Copilot rollout. He needs the org-wide **adoption report** to track the programme. He is *not* a people-manager — he has no direct reports — and he holds no admin role. The instinctive move is "he's an exec, just give him *manager* access." That doesn't work, and it's worth understanding why.

Why "manager" is the wrong lever. In Viva Insights, "*manager*" is not a statement about seniority or importance — it is a literal test of whether the person has **direct or indirect reports**, established by the `PersonId` / `ManagerId` hierarchy. You cannot enable someone as a manager who has nobody reporting to them, no matter how senior they are. And even if James *did* have a small team, manager access would only show **that team's** adoption — not the **company-wide** view an executive sponsor actually needs.

The correct lever here is delegation. James could receive company access through explicit assignment, qualifying senior-leader identification, Global-partition analyst assignment, Global Administrator, or an eligible company-scoped delegation. For a read-only sponsor who does not otherwise qualify, delegation is the least-privilege choice; do not assign an administrative or analyst role merely to create a view.

Step	Action
1	Identify a delegator who already has company-level access — a senior leader with automatic access, or a Global Administrator.
2	That leader opens the Copilot Dashboard → Settings → Delegation → Add delegates , adds James, and assigns a role.
3	Confirm James holds the required Viva Insights / Copilot entitlement , which is necessary but not sufficient.
4	Check no VFAM gate blocks James's group from the Viva Insights web app / Copilot Dashboard.
5	James opens the Viva Insights web app → Reports and sees the org-wide adoption report under the delegating leader's name.

Delegation caveats to set expectations

- A delegate sees the surface *as the delegating leader* — a banner shows whose insights they're viewing.
- Delegation is capped at **75 delegates** per leader and **cannot cascade** (James can't re-delegate).
- If the delegating leader loses their own access (e.g. leaves the org), **James's access is revoked too** — so prefer a stable senior leader or a Global Admin as the delegator.

This matches Microsoft Learn exactly: the Copilot Analytics reports prerequisites list automatic access, *delegate* access, Insights Analyst, or Global Admin — with no “promote a non-manager to manager” path — and the delegate-access guidance confirms a company-scoped delegation is how a non-manager gets the org-wide view.

Deliberately restricting access (the inverse problem)

The harder, higher-stakes version of this question is the reverse: **“How do I make sure a particular leader or group *cannot* see the dashboard, even though their role or hierarchy would normally grant it?”** This is the everyday reality in regulated, multi-agency, or shared-tenant deployments where one agency’s leaders must not see another’s data.

Some access sources are automatic, including qualified senior-leader and enabled manager access. The **VFAM gate is the supported surface-control lever for removing access:**

Goal	How
Block a specific set of users from the dashboard	Create a group-scoped VFAM policy that turns the Viva Insights we
Let agency managers see <i>only</i> their own agency	Combine the VFAM block above with partition-based isolation so tha
Confirm a block actually took effect	Have a test user in the blocked group sign out / in and load analysis

Use group-scoped policies, never “Everyone”

The most common multi-agency mistake is blocking the Copilot Dashboard at the “Everyone” level to lock down agency users — which also blocks senior executives and central admins who are supposed to see tenant-wide adoption. Always target a dedicated Entra group (e.g. `AgencyUsers-NoDashboard`). See the Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture for the full group-scoped lockdown pattern.

What “done” looks like

- You can name the exact source that grants **your** access and scope, plus the required entitlement and absence of a VFAM block.
- You’ve confirmed the colleague either has no qualifying source — in which case it’s **correct by design** — or you’ve found the missing item: explicit access, Global partition, eligible hierarchy, Manager Settings, delegation, entitlement, or VFAM.
- If the goal was the *inverse* — restricting access — the right users are blocked via a **group-scoped** VFAM policy (never “Everyone”), verified by a test user in the blocked group.

Related

- [Troubleshooting Scenarios catalogue](#) — browse all scenarios.
 - [Troubleshooting Guide](#) — symptom-tables for single-surface lookups.
 - [Dashboard Guide](#) — access scopes, delegation, and the Reports surface.
 - [Admin Setup Guide](#) — role assignment and Manager Settings step.
 - [Privacy Configuration Guide](#) — minimum team size vs. minimum group size.
 - [Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture](#) — group-scoped VFAM lockdown and partition-based data isolation.
 - [FAQ](#) — common access questions.
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